

two CTRL keys on either side of the keyboard and then pressing the C key. It does not mean pressing the CTRL key once, followed by pressing the C key.

You can discover the common shortcuts, such as CTRL-S to save and CTRL-C to copy, by using the mouse to open the menu bar at the top of the application (in Windows and Linux) or top of the screen (in macOS). It's well worth the time to learn and use these keyboard shortcuts.

Other shortcuts are not so obvious. For example, ALT-TAB on Windows and Linux and COMMAND-TAB on macOS allow you to switch focus to another application's window. You can hold the ALT or COMMAND key down and repeatedly press TAB to select a specific window to switch to.

Copying and Pasting

The *clipboard* is a feature of your operating system that can temporarily store data for pasting. While this data can be text, images, files, or other types of information, we'll be dealing with text data in this section. *Copying* text places a copy of the currently selected text onto the clipboard. *Pasting* text enters the text on the clipboard into wherever the text cursor currently is, as though you had instantly typed it yourself. Copying and pasting text frees you from having to retype text that already exists on your computer, whether it's a single line or hundreds of pages.

To copy and paste text, first select, or *highlight*, the text to copy. You can do this by holding down the primary mouse button (which is the left button, if the mouse is set for right-handed users) and dragging over the text to select it. However, holding down the SHIFT key and moving the cursor with the keyboard shortcuts is often faster and more precise. Many applications allow you to double-click a word to immediately select the entire word. You can also often triple-click to immediately select an entire line or paragraph.

The next step is to press CTRL-C on Windows or COMMAND-C on macOS to copy the selected text to the clipboard. The clipboard can only hold one selection of text, so copying text replaces anything that was previously on the clipboard.

Finally, move the cursor to where you want the text to appear and press CTRL-V on Windows or COMMAND-V on macOS to paste the text. You can paste as many times as you want; the text remains on the clipboard until you copy new text to replace it.

Finding and Replacing Text

Dan Russell, a search anthropologist at Google, explained in a 2011 *Atlantic* article that when he studied people's computer usage habits, 90 percent of them didn't know they could press CTRL-F (on Windows and Linux) or COMMAND-F (on macOS) to search for words in their applications. This is an incredibly useful feature, not just in code editors, but in word processors, web browsers, spreadsheet applications, and almost every kind